

core service offering or is part of an administrative function. As an example, HR and payroll functions can be outsourced from a technology perspective for significantly lower cost as compared to developing in-house software applications.

Nine blocks of core business functions have been identified where typical organisations like to have all or some level of in-house application development. Table 1 looks at each business function for its core capability and the OSS options for it.

Most organisations have some exposure to open source software, including that which is sold commercially. Today, there is a

range of open source software to choose from to build every desired business function of the organisation. As long as one is willing to take the time in

understanding the requirements, there is some open source software readily available to get started with greenfield technology implementation. 

References

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By: Bala Kalavala

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who ensure that you don't remain in that well but also go out and see what is going on around the world, because they are meeting multiple people like you across the industry. They can give you that reality check and sometimes be the nudge that puts you on the right path."

Apart from that, they also look into things like validation core, crowd infrastructure, as well as technology infrastructure. It's not possible for a hardware startup to have huge infrastructure right away, which is why being part of an incubator is so valuable.

The bad and the ugly

Creating anything of your own is as exhausting as it is exhilarating. Every successful startup is the result of the sweat, blood, and tears poured into it by its founders. As inspirational as it sounds, sometimes a lack of cushioning, either financially or emotionally, can do more harm than good. This is more so in present times where startups are evolving every day and it is getting increasingly difficult to set yourself apart.

"A lot of entrepreneurs and founders are exploiting themselves. They are working without taking a break, not being paid salaries, not taking care of themselves nor the people around them. What they're doing is they're just killing themselves, which they shouldn't," notes Shastry.

Even so, Jayaraju argues that too much cushioning can also have an adverse effect such as complacency. "You do not need to be self-exploitive but at the same time, unless there are sacrifices made or there is sole devotion to a certain cause, you may not end up making great products or solutions, because you have a backup. So, the answer really lies in questioning yourself: How much risk are you willing to take?"

The formula for creating a successful startup has not changed much post-pandemic.

However, the importance of building a robust product or solution as a tech startup has never been made clearer. With the future looking bright for startups, the founders need to find the middle ground between their passion, customers, and what would make money.

In conclusion, Ray states, "The startup founder is 'a buck stops with me' journey. You and the founding team are alone, and once you let that seep into your flesh and blood with added thick skin, you are mentally ready whatever the time may be." 

The article is based on the panel discussion 'Idea To Startup: How To Do It?' presented at September edition of Tech World Congress 2020.

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